# They Glorified the *God of Israel*

*I feel compassion for the crowd.*

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 15:29-39 in the LSB | 19:53 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Most Overlooked Miracle in the Bible – and Why You Can't Miss It!. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

## Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 15:29-39. Jesus goes along the Sea of Galilee, goes up on the mountain and sits down. Large crowds bring the lame, crippled, blind and mute, and He heals them, so that they glorify the God of Israel. After three days He has compassion on the crowd and feeds four thousand men, besides women and children, with seven loaves and a few small fish; seven large baskets are left over.
- Location matters. Mark places this stretch 'within the region of the Decapolis' (Mark 7:31), east of the Jordan and the lake. The video calls the Jordan a kind of boundary between Jews and pagans, so after the Canaanite woman Jesus is again among Gentiles, physically and in what He teaches.
- The healings echo Exodus 4:11 and Psalm 146:8: the God of Israel makes the mute and the blind, and He opens the eyes of the blind. The crowd draws the conclusion and glorifies Israel's God.
- Jesus Himself asks about the numbers (Mark 8:18-21). The video reads four as the four corners of the earth, so four thousand is the community of the Gentiles; seven loaves and seven baskets speak of completion. It wonders whether the disciples' question assumed Jesus would not show Gentiles the same mercy.

> *"And they glorified the God of Israel.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Location matters.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: because the Lord has compassion on those who don't know Him, He mercifully gives His teaching and Himself to all, not just Jews. The video links this to the Gentile mission in Acts.



*He healed them on the mountain*

James Tissot, Jesus Heals the Blind and Lame on the Mountain, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

### Ask where you are

The teacher says location matters. Mark tells us Jesus came 'within the region of the Decapolis' (Mark 7:31); reading Matthew with a map shows who was in the crowd and why the crowd praised 'the God of Israel.'

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

## Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 15:29-39 and turns to Mark 7 and 8, Exodus 4, Psalm 146 and the book of Acts. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

**Matthew 15:29-39**
Read in full: healings on the mountain and the feeding of the four thousand.

**Mark 7:31-37**
Through Sidon to the Decapolis; a deaf man healed.

**Mark 8:1-10**
Mark's account of the four thousand.

**Mark 8:14-21**
'Do you not yet understand?' The baskets again.

**Exodus 4:11**

**Psalms 146:8**

Who makes him mute or deaf, seeing or blind?

Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind.

**Matthew 9:35-36**
Compassion on the crowds of Israel.

**Matthew 14:13-21**
The five thousand, for comparison.

**Acts 10:34-35**
God is not one to show partiality.

**Matthew 16:1-20**
Coming next: the sign of Jonah and Peter's confession.

### Key verses in the LSB

"So the crowd marveled as they saw the mute speaking, the crippled restored, and the lame walking, and the blind seeing; and they glorified the God of Israel."
Matthew 15:31 (LSB)

"And Jesus called His disciples to Him, and said, "I feel compassion for the crowd, because they have remained with Me now three days and have nothing to eat; and I do not want to send them away hungry, lest they faint on the way.""
Matthew 15:32 (LSB)

"And they all ate and were satisfied, and they picked up what was left over of the broken pieces, seven large baskets full."
Matthew 15:37 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

# Healing on the mountain

Where Jesus was, who came, and the God they praised.



MARK 7:31; MATTHEW 15:29

## Within the region of the Decapolis

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 15:29
"And departing from there, Jesus went along by the Sea of Galilee, and having gone up on the mountain, He was sitting there."

MARK · MARK 7:31
"And again He went out from the region of Tyre, and came through Sidon to the Sea of Galilee, within the region of the Decapolis."

FROM THE VIDEO Matthew only says 'by the Sea of Galilee'; Mark tells us where: the Decapolis, the ten cities. The video says the Jordan became a kind of boundary between the Jews on the west and the pagans on the east.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus has just withdrawn to Tyre and Sidon (15:21). He keeps moving away from Israel, physically and in what He teaches: after rejecting the Pharisees' purity rules, He goes to Gentiles.

◆ Factbook: Decapolis ◆ Factbook: Sea of Galilee ◆ Factbook: Tyre ◆ Factbook: Sidon

MATTHEW 15:29-30

## He went up the mountain and sat

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 15:29

“And departing from there, Jesus went along by the Sea of Galilee, and having gone up on the mountain, He was sitting there.”

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 5:1

“Now when Jesus saw the crowds, He went up on the mountain; and after He sat down, His disciples came to Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO Sitting is the posture of a teacher. Jesus has been sitting, which the video says means He was likely teaching the people as well as healing them.

BACKGROUND The same words open the Sermon on the Mount (5:1). Large crowds had already come 'from Galilee and the Decapolis' (Matthew 4:25). Matthew 4:25

◆ Factbook: Sermon on the Mount

EXODUS 4:11; PSALM 146:8

## The God who makes the mute and the blind

YAHWEH TO MOSES · EXODUS 4:11

“And Yahweh said to him, “Who has made man’s mouth? Or who makes him mute or deaf, or seeing or blind? Is it not I, Yahweh?”

THE PSALMIST · PSALMS 146:8

“Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind; / Yahweh raises up those who are bowed down; / Yahweh loves the righteous;”

FROM THE VIDEO The lame, crippled, blind and mute are healed. The video says the crowd would think of Exodus 4 and Psalm 146 and make the connection: only Yahweh does this.

BACKGROUND Isaiah promises the same signs: 'Then the eyes of the blind will be opened' and 'the tongue of the mute will shout for joy' (Isaiah 35:5-6). Isaiah 35:5-6

◆ Factbook: Healing ◆ Factbook: Moses ◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms

MATTHEW 15:31

## They glorified the God of Israel

MATTHEW 15:31 (LSB)

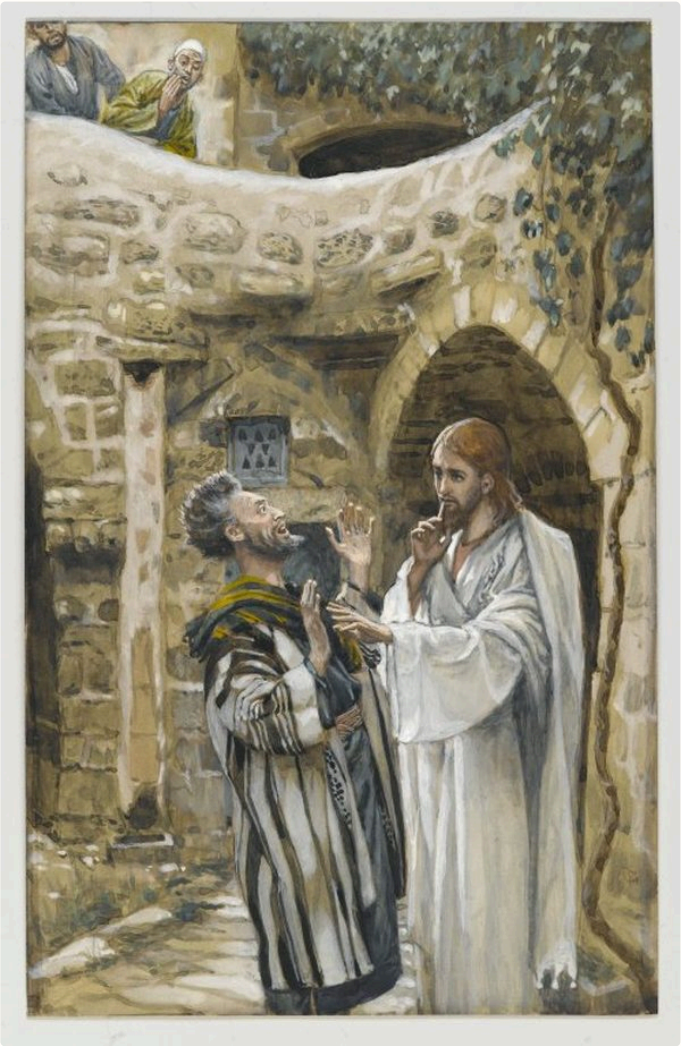
GENTILES

“So the crowd marveled as they saw the mute speaking, the crippled restored, and the lame walking, and the blind seeing; and they glorified the God of Israel.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'These are the pagans,' the video says. They don't know Torah, yet they glorify the God of Israel.

BACKGROUND Mark's crowd says, 'He has done all things well; He makes even the deaf to hear and the mute to speak' (Mark 7:37). Mark 7:37

◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Worship



*The mute speaking*

James Tissot, Jesus Heals a Mute Possessed Man, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *Location matters.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

# Bread for the Gentiles

The same compassion, the same meal, a different crowd.

MATTHEW 15:32; 9:36

## Compassion now on Gentiles

ISRAEL'S CROWDS · MATTHEW 9:36

“And seeing the crowds, He felt compassion for them, because they were distressed and downcast like sheep without a shepherd.”

THE FOUR THOUSAND · MATTHEW 15:32

“And Jesus called His disciples to Him, and said, “I feel compassion for the crowd, because they have remained with Me now three days and have nothing

to eat; and I do not want to send them away hungry, lest they faint on the way.”””

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus feeds them with the same meal, loaves and fish. He did it for God's people in chapter 14; now He does it for the Gentiles in chapter 15.

◆ Factbook: Compassion ◆ Factbook: Jesus feeds the 5,000



MATTHEW 15:33

## Where would we get so many loaves?

🤔 MATTHEW 15:33 (LSB) QUESTION

“And the disciples *said to Him, “Where would we get so many loaves in this desolate place to satisfy such a large crowd?””

FROM THE VIDEO They had just seen Him feed five thousand. Could it be, the video asks, that they assumed Jesus would not extend the same mercy to Gentiles as He did to Jews?

FROM THE VIDEO It even wonders whether some disciples hesitated to hand bread to pagans, then adds: the text doesn't say it, so I'm not going to make too much of it.

◆ Factbook: Disciples



MATTHEW 15:35-37

## Teaching for those who don't know Torah

🍞 MATTHEW 15:36-37 (LSB) BREAD

“and He took the seven loaves and the fish; and giving thanks, He broke them and kept giving them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the crowds. And they all ate and were satisfied, and they picked up what was left over of the broken pieces, seven large baskets full.”

FROM THE VIDEO In a Jew's mind, the video says, bread refers to teaching. Jesus gives His perfect teaching to His disciples, and they in turn feed Gentiles with it.

FROM THE VIDEO When these Gentiles, who don't know the law of God, eat Jesus' law, there is more than enough left over to keep feeding all the Gentiles.

◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Law of Moses



ACTS 10:34-35

## A lesson for the book of Acts

🌍 ACTS 10:34-35 (LSB) MISSION

“And opening his mouth, Peter said: “I most truly comprehend now that God is not one to show partiality, but in every nation the one who fears Him and does righteousness is welcome to Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO The video says the disciples have to wrestle with this lesson, especially as it extends into the book of Acts. It challenges purity traditions and preconceived notions of how God operates.

BACKGROUND Peter learns it in Cornelius' house (Acts 10). Paul and Barnabas quote Isaiah 49:6: 'I have placed You as a light for the Gentiles' (Acts 13:47). Acts 13:47 Isaiah 49:6

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Centurion ◆ Factbook: Paul

> *“This is a lesson that challenges purity traditions.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

# Four thousand, seven loaves, seven baskets

The video's reading of the numbers in the second feeding.



MARK 8:18-21

## Do you not remember?

MARK 8:19-21 (LSB) THE KEY

“when I broke the five loaves for the five thousand, how many baskets full of broken pieces you picked up?” They *said to Him, “Twelve.” “When I broke the seven for the four thousand, how many large baskets full of broken pieces did you pick up?” And they *said to Him, “Seven.” And He was saying to them, “Do you not yet understand?””

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus calls out the numbers Himself. The two meals are alike, but the number of loaves, people and baskets are different, and that difference is the lesson.

◆ Factbook: The Twelve



THE VIDEO'S NUMBER KEY

## Four corners, four thousand

FROM THE VIDEO The video repeats its number chart: one for God, two for the tablets, three for the patriarchs or unity, seven for completion, twelve for the tribes, a thousand for a community.

FROM THE VIDEO Four is the four corners of the earth, the nations. So four thousand stands for the community of the Gentiles, as five thousand stood for the community of those who follow the books of Moses.

BACKGROUND Isaiah speaks of gathering the dispersed 'from the four corners of the earth' (Isaiah 11:12). Isaiah 11:12

◆ Factbook: Gematria



MATTHEW 15:34-37

## Seven loaves, seven baskets

THE LOAVES · MATTHEW 15:34

“And Jesus *said to them, “How many loaves do you have?” And they said, “Seven, and a few small fish.””

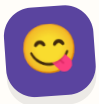
THE LEFTOVERS · MATTHEW 15:37

“And they all ate and were satisfied, and they picked up what was left over of the broken pieces, seven

large baskets full.”

FROM THE VIDEO Seven stands for completion: Jesus' complete teaching fills the whole Gentile community, with a complete supply left over.

BACKGROUND Matthew uses a different word for the baskets here (spyris) than at the five thousand (kophinos); Jesus keeps the two words apart in 16:9-10. Matthew 16:9-10



THE LESSON

### To all, not just Jews

FROM THE VIDEO Because the Lord has compassion on those who don't know Him, He mercifully gives His teaching and Himself to all, not just Jews, to all.

FROM THE VIDEO The video closes by asking whether we have the mind of Christ on this today, and points again to 15:31: these pagans glorified the God of Israel.

◆ Factbook: Mercy

> *“And they glorified the God of Israel.*
>
> Matthew 15:31, quoted in the video

06

## Who's who in 15:29-39

What the video says, then a short background note.

### The crowds

VIDEO Gentiles of the Decapolis who bring their sick, stay three days, and glorify the God of Israel.

BACKGROUND Mark says some had 'come from a great distance' (Mark 8:3).

Mark 8:3 ◆ Gentiles ◆ Decapolis

### The lame, crippled, blind and mute

VIDEO Laid at Jesus' feet and healed.

BACKGROUND Mark tells of a deaf man with a speech impediment healed with the word 'Ephphatha' (Mark 7:34).

Mark 7:32-35 ◆ Healing

### The disciples

VIDEO Ask where they could get enough bread; then serve it to Gentiles.

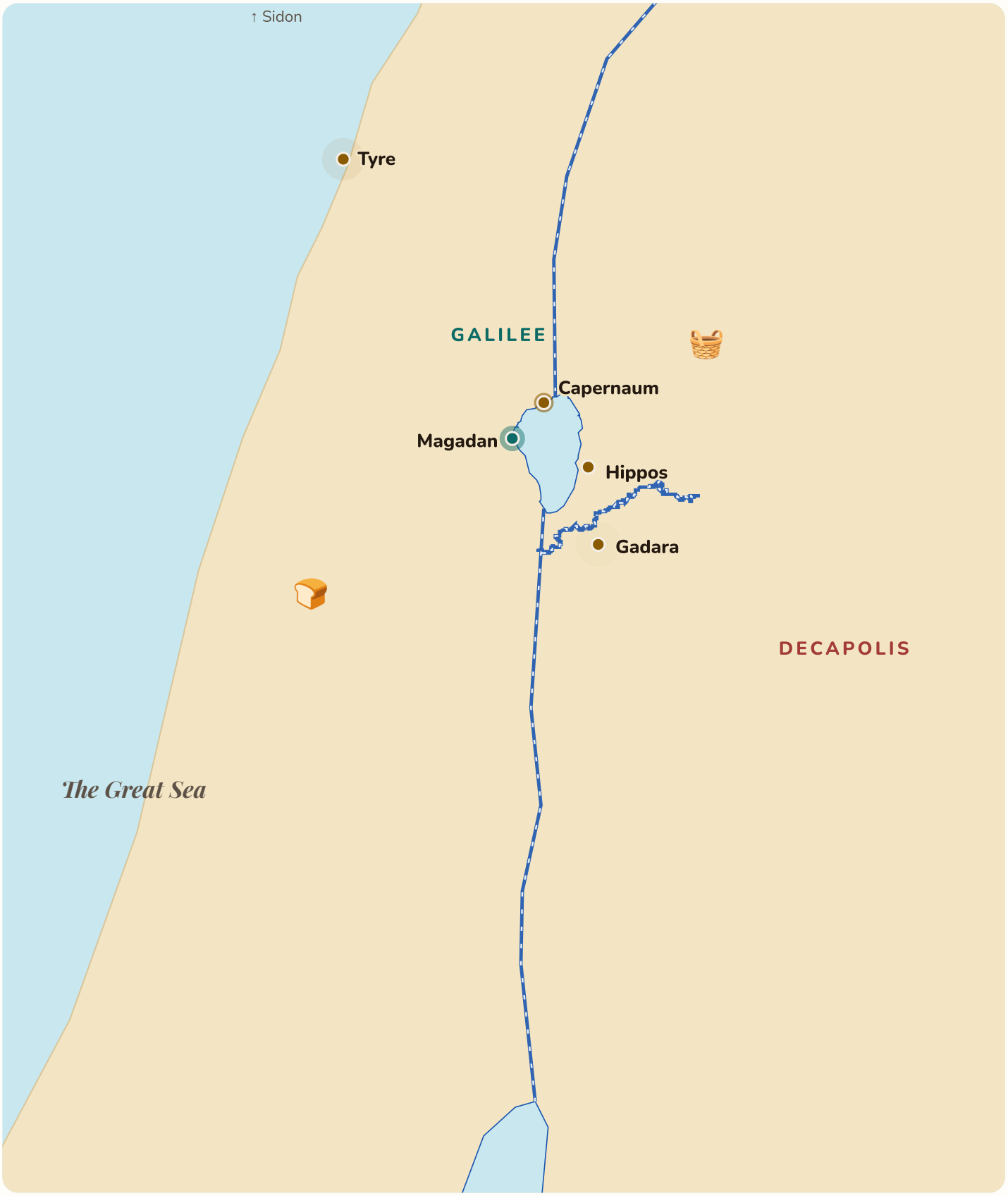
BACKGROUND In Mark 8:17 Jesus asks, 'Do you have a hardened heart?'

Mark 8:17 ◆ Disciples ◆ The Twelve

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

# Galilee and the Decapolis

Gold pins are background; the pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names.



Positions from known sites; Sidon lies just north of this map. The Decapolis was a loose league of cities, mostly east of the Jordan; Scythopolis lay west of it. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

**Magadan** VIDEO
Jesus sails to 'the region of Magadan' afterward (15:39); usually linked with Magdala. The captions write 'Magodan.'

◆ Factbook: Magdala ◆ Factbook: Magadan

**Capernaum** BACKGROUND
Jesus' base on the north shore.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

**Hippos** BACKGROUND
One of the Decapolis cities, on a ridge above the east shore.

◆ Factbook: Hippos

**Gadara** BACKGROUND
Another Decapolis city, south-east of the lake (8:28).

◆ Factbook: Gadara

**Tyre** BACKGROUND
Where Jesus came from (15:21; Mark 7:31).

◆ Factbook: Tyre

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# Key terms

### Decapolis
VIDEO
'Ten cities': a league of Greek-style cities, mostly east of the Jordan. The captions write 'dicapus' and 'decapus.'

◆ Factbook: Decapolis

### Gentiles
VIDEO
The nations, non-Jews; the video's 'pagans.'

◆ Factbook: Gentiles

### Gematria
VIDEO
As the video uses it, attaching deeper meaning to numbers. The captions write 'Gamatria.'

◆ Factbook: Gematria

### Remez
VIDEO
A hint back to an Old Testament passage, here Exodus 4:11 and Psalm 146:8.

◆ Factbook: Tanakh

### Purity traditions
VIDEO
Rules about clean and unclean; the video says this meal challenges them.

◆

### Magadan
BACKGROUND
The place Jesus sails to (15:39); Mark has Dalmanutha (Mark 8:10). Both sites are uncertain.

◆ ◆

Factbook: Unclean (ritual purity)

Factbook: Magdala

Factbook: Magadan

09 · BACKGROUND

# Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

## κωφός

***kōphos*** G2974

Mute; also deaf. Blunted in speech or hearing.

Greek · Matt 15:30, 31

## κυλλός

***kyllos*** G2948

Crippled, maimed (of a limb).

Greek · Matt 15:30, 31

## δοξάζω

***doxazō*** G1392

To glorify, praise, honor.

Greek · Matt 15:31

◆ Factbook: Worship

## σπλαγχνίζομαι

***splanchnizomai*** G4697

To feel compassion, to be moved in one's inner parts. Look up: BDAG, σπλαγχνίζομαι.

Greek · Matt 15:32; 9:36

◆ Factbook: Compassion

## εὐχαριστέω

***eucharisteō*** G2168

To give thanks.

Greek · Matt 15:36

## σπυρίς

***spyris*** G4711

A large basket or hamper, the kind used to let Paul down a wall (Acts 9:25).

Greek · Matt 15:37; 16:10

## κόφινος

***kophinos*** G2894

Basket, the word used at the five thousand.

Greek · Matt 16:9

## אִלֵּם

***illem*** H483

Mute, unable to speak.

Hebrew · Exod 4:11

## פָּקַח

***paqach*** H6491

To open (the eyes). Look up: BDB or HALOT, פקח.

Hebrew · Ps 146:8

# Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED

## Facts most interpreters agree on

### The Decapolis

The ten cities, among them Hippos, Gadara, Gerasa and Scythopolis, were Greek in language and culture, with temples to Greek gods. Pliny the Elder lists ten, though ancient lists differ. Pigs were raised there (8:30-32), a sign of a largely Gentile population.

### Two feedings

Matthew and Mark record both feedings, and Jesus refers to both (Matthew 16:9-10; Mark 8:19-20). Many readers see the first among Jews and the second among Gentiles, though Matthew does not say so outright.

### Magadan and Dalmanutha

Matthew's Magadan and Mark's Dalmanutha (Mark 8:10) are otherwise unknown. Some copyists wrote Magdala, the fishing town on the west shore, and many readers place the landing there.

SOURCED

## Early witnesses

> *For the multitudes indeed who had come out for healing dared not ask for the loaves; but He, the benevolent and provident one, gives even to them that ask not*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 53, on 15:32. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *lest the equality of the miracle should again cast them into forgetfulness, He rouses their recollection by the difference, that by the variation they might be reminded of both one and the other.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 53, on 15:37-38. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

## Where scholars differ

### Was the crowd Gentile?

Mark's setting in the Decapolis and the phrase 'the God of Israel' lead many to read the crowd as largely Gentile. Others note that Jews also lived in the region and that Matthew does not say so.

### Do the numbers carry meaning?

Jesus does draw attention to the numbers (16:9-10). Seeing seven as fullness is common; reading four thousand as 'the Gentile community' is the video's own key.

### One feeding or two?

Some critics suggest one event told twice. Matthew and Mark present two, and Jesus speaks of both (Mark 8:19-20).

CAREFUL READING

### Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video first says 'Exodus 4:1' and then reads verse 11. The verse about the mute and the blind is Exodus 4:11.
- 'Roman numerals ... didn't exist back then' is a slip: Roman numerals did exist. The point is that Arabic numerals (the ones we use today) did not, and Hebrew letters doubled as numbers.
- Matthew does not name the Decapolis here; the setting comes from Mark 7:31. The Decapolis also had a city west of the Jordan (Scythopolis).
- The chart of number meanings is the video's own; the Bible does not give such a key. What the video calls gematria is broader number symbolism.
- The captions write 'Magodan' for Magadan, 'dicapus' and 'decapus' for Decapolis, 'Ty and Sidon' for Tyre and Sidon, and 'Gamatria' for gematria.

II · BACKGROUND

## From Moses to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 15:29-39 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED
**Yahweh: 'Who makes him mute or deaf?'**
Exodus 4:11 *Remez: 15:30-31*

C. 500 BC DEBATED
**Psalm 146: Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind**
Psalms 146:8 *Remez*

C. 63 BC
**Pompey frees the Decapolis cities under Rome**
Mark 5:20

C. AD 29 DEBATED
**Jesus feeds the five thousand**
Matthew 14:13-21

C. AD 29 DEBATED
**Jesus heals and feeds four thousand by the lake**
Matthew 15:29-39 *This episode*

C. AD 40 DEBATED
**Peter at Cornelius' house: God shows no partiality**

Acts 10:34-35

C. AD 390

**Chrysostom: He gives even to them that ask not**

Matthew 15:32

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# Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 7:31-8:10
Mark's parallel and setting
ADDED

Mark 8:14-21
The lesson of the baskets
ADDED

Isaiah 35:5-6
The blind see, the mute shout for joy
ADDED

Isaiah 49:6
A light of the nations
ADDED

Isaiah 25:6
A feast for all peoples on the mountain
ADDED

Acts 10:34-35
God shows no partiality
ADDED

Ephesians 2:11-14
Gentiles brought near
ADDED

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# Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ Why might Matthew place this feeding right after the Canaanite woman?

2 ☐ The crowd glorified 'the God of Israel.' What did they see that led them there?

3 ☐ The video wonders whether the disciples expected less mercy for Gentiles. Whom do you quietly expect God to pass over?

4 ☐ Jesus felt compassion before anyone asked for bread. What does that show about Him?

5 ☐ How far would you take the number symbolism? Where would you be cautious?

6 ☐ Do you have the mind of Christ toward people who don't know Him?

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# Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson, stated plainly: because the Lord has compassion on those who don't know Him, He mercifully gives His teaching and Himself to all, not just Jews, to all. This lesson challenges purity traditions and preconceived notions of how God operates. The disciples have to consider not only what God is doing around them but who Jesus is and what He has truly come to this earth to do, a lesson that extends into the book of Acts. These Gentiles did not know Torah, did not know anything, and they glorified the God of Israel. Does this still teach today? Do we have the mind of Christ on this issue today?

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

read Matthew 15:21-39 in one sitting, the Canaanite woman and then the four thousand. Then name one person or group you find hard to imagine at Jesus' table, and pray for them by name this week.

> *"Because the Lord has compassion on those who don't know him, he mercifully gives his teaching and himself to all, not just Jews, to all.*
>
> From the video

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# Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Moses ◆ Jordan River ◆ Isaiah ◆ Pharisees ◆ Galilee ◆ Righteousness ◆ Capernaum ◆ Decapolis ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Fishing ◆ Gadara ◆ Gentiles ◆ Gerasa ◆ Healing ◆ Hippos ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Magdala ◆ Mercy ◆ Prayer ◆ Beth-shan (Scythopolis) ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Sermon on the Mount ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Centurion ◆ Paul ◆ Swine ◆ Tanakh ◆ Compassion ◆ Shepherd ◆ Sidon ◆ Tyre

◆ Canaanites ◆ Unclean (ritual purity) ◆ Jesus feeds the 5,000 ◆ Gematria ◆ Jesus feeds the 4,000 ◆ Magadan

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; public domain). Map data: Natural Earth (public domain) and OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-30/